Install the beta as its own app

Mech Sketch beta in a window of its own, with its own desktop icon, beside the released app. It takes about a minute in Chrome or Edge.



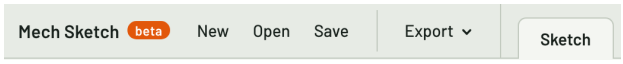
released app beta

What you get

- An app called **Mech Sketch beta**, with the orange **b** on its icon, in its own window, on the desktop and in the Start menu.
- It runs beside the released app; installing it changes nothing about the released one.
- It keeps its own sketch: work in one never shows up in the other.

Steps

1. **Open the beta in Chrome or Edge: mech-sketch.org/beta/**
   The address ends in `/beta/`. Without it, you get the released app.
2. **Load the newest version:** press Ctrl + Shift + R (Cmd + Shift + R on a Mac).
3. **Check that it is the beta:** the orange **beta** tag is beside the name, top left.



4. **Install it.** Click the **install icon** at the right end of the address bar, then **Install**. Or use the browser's menu:
   Chrome ⋮ › **Cast, save, and share** › **Install page as app...**
   Edge ··· › **Apps** › **Install this site as an app**

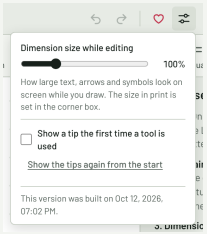
   Released app already installed? Then Chrome offers only *Open in Mech Sketch* instead of installing. Use ⋮ › **Cast, save, and share** › **Create shortcut...**, name it **Mech Sketch beta**, tick **Open as window** and choose **Create**.

5. **Done.** The beta opens in its own window. Next time, start it from its icon on the desktop or in the Start menu.
   No desktop icon? In Chrome, open `chrome://apps`, right-click *Mech Sketch beta* and choose **Create shortcuts...**

Keeping it up to date

The beta updates itself: each time it starts online, it loads the newest version that has been published. If something looks out of date, press Ctrl + Shift + R in its window.

To see which version you have, open **View settings** (the sliders, top right). The last line says when it was built.



Sketches and files

Each app keeps its own sketch in the browser, so the two never overwrite each other.

Save and **Open** work in both. A file saved in the beta with something new in it, such as a plot or a spring, may not show those parts when it is opened in the released app, until they are released.

Removing it

In the beta's window, open the menu at the top right and choose **Uninstall Mech Sketch beta**. The released app stays.

Or right-click it on `chrome://apps` (`edge://apps` in Edge) and remove it there.

On a Mac

Chrome and Edge work the same way. Safari can do it too: **File** › **Add to Dock**.

Released app: mech-sketch.org Beta: mech-sketch.org/beta/ Problems? The report button, top right in the app